gentle – gentler – gentlest / gentle – more gentle – most gentle]

- A few adjectives and adverbs form their comparatives and superlatives in an irregular way. *[e.g. good – better – best / little – less, lesser – least / old – older, elder – oldest, eldest]*
- There are certain comparatives that end in '-or'.They are followed by 'to' instead of 'than'. *[e.g. Marble flooring is superior to mosaic flooring. / Ravi is junior to me.]*
- The adjectives in superlative degree are preceded by the definite article 'the'. *[e.g. The Nobel prize is the highest award given to scientists. / The Japanese are the most industrious people.]*
- The article 'the' is often omitted before superlative adverbs. *[e.g. John climbed (the) highest of all cadets.]*
- The definite article 'the' is not used before superlatives that follow a noun in possessive case. *[e.g. That should be Robert's worst experience in all of his childhood days.]*
- Comparison of equals is expressed by 'as + adjective + as'. In the negative comparison, 'so + adjective + as' is often used instead of 'as + adjective + as'. *[e.g. Ooty is as cool as Kodaikanal. / Bangalore isn't so cool as Yercaud.]*
- The adjectives in comparative degree are generally used to indicate apposition and are followed by 'than'. They are also followed by 'of' when it denotes selection. *[e.g. Radha is taller than Anu. / Radha is the taller of the two.]*
- We use 'the' with adjectives in comparative degree to show that one thing depends on another. *[e.g. The deeper you breathe, the calmer you become.*
- Sentences with adjectives and adverbs in one particular Degree of Comparison can be transformed into other degrees of comparison without changing their meaning.
- Here are a few examples that show how various types of sentences in different Degrees of Comparison can be interchanged.

Type -1

- No other profession is as **noble** as teaching.
- Teaching is **nobler** than any other profession.
- Teaching is the **noblest** of all professions. / Teaching is the noblest profession.

Type – 2

- Very few professions are as **noble** as teaching.
- Teaching is **nobler** than many other / most other professions.
- Teaching is one of the **noblest** professions.

Type – 3

- Apples are costlier than mangoes in the summer season.
- Mangoes are not so costly as apples in the summer season.

Type – 4

- Apples are not more expensive than mangoes during winter.

12th General_English_Unit_5_A_Prose.indd 158 07-12-2021 18:13:05